

Accept Decisions

There are two types of accept decisions: editorial accept and formal accept.

Editorial accept

Editorial acceptance means that the manuscript is provisionally accepted pending final checks for formatting and technical requirements. You will be notified of these requirements by email. See details of our final checks below.

The editorial acceptance date is the acceptance date that will appear on the published article.

Formal accept

Formal acceptance is issued when the final checks are complete. At this time, the manuscript will be sent to our production department.

Communication with authors

All communication about editorial accept decisions and final checks will be sent to the corresponding author. When the manuscript is formally accepted, all authors will be notified.

Final Checks

When a manuscript is editorially accepted, it will go through a final round of checks to ensure the formatting and content meet our technical requirements. Some of the manuscript elements checked at this stage include:

- › Author names and affiliations
- › Funding statement
- › Competing interests statement
- › Data availability statement
- › Figure and table formatting
- › File names for figures, tables, and supporting information

You can expedite the progress of your manuscript during this stage by reviewing our submission guidelines beforehand and by responding promptly to our queries.

- ❗ When you receive a decision of editorial accept, this will be your last opportunity to correct any errors in your manuscript. Please check your files very carefully, because you will not be able to check or change anything after this point.

Peer Review History

If your submission is accepted for publication, you'll be invited to opt-in to publish the peer review history of your manuscript using a form in our submission system. The peer review history package includes the editorial decision letter for each revision, with reviews, and your responses to reviewer comments, including attachments. Read more about [published peer review history](#).

Author Proof Review

Once a manuscript has been accepted for publication, the files are sent to our production department. The manuscript is edited by a professional editor who will raise queries as necessary with the author about revisions to the manuscript text and figures during the proof review.

- ❗ It is critical that you check your manuscript text, figures, and tables very carefully when you see the composed proof.

Please note that supporting information files are not edited and will not be typeset, but rather provided for download directly from the article.

Once the article has been composed, you will receive a link to the IMPACT system to review your article proof.

PLOS permits the following types of corrections to the PDF proof:

- › Errors in author names or affiliation
- › Errors of scientific fact that would cause misunderstandings to readers

› Printer's (introduced) errors

Correction requests beyond these items can result in a publication delay of a week minimum, possibly longer depending on the request. There is one round of proof review, and this is the last time you will see your article before publication, so the corresponding author should review the proof carefully and collect all author input at that time.

You can expedite the production process and avoid publication delays by giving prompt attention during proof review.

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Press and Media

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